DigitalSolutions - Company Handbook

Version 3.2 - Last updated: September 2026

This is a fictional sample document created for testing purposes.

1. About DigitalSolutions

DigitalSolutions is a software development and IT services company headquartered in Multan, Pakistan. The company was founded in 2015 by Imran Qureshi, who still serves as the Chief Executive Officer (CEO). What started as a three-person web development studio has grown into a full-service technology company with more than 100 staff members.

Our mission is to help businesses grow through reliable, modern, and affordable software. Our vision is to become the most trusted technology partner in South Punjab by 2030.

Core Values

1. **Quality first** - We do not ship work we are not proud of.
2. **Honesty** - We tell clients the truth about timelines, costs, and risks.
3. **Learning** - Every employee is encouraged to learn something new every month.
4. **Teamwork** - We win and lose as one team.
5. **Respect** - We respect our colleagues, clients, and their time.

Leadership Team

Name	Role
Imran Qureshi	Chief Executive Officer (CEO)
Sana Malik	Chief Technology Officer (CTO)
Bilal Ahmed	Chief Operating Officer (COO)
Ayesha Khan	Head of Human Resources
Usman Tariq	Head of Sales and Business Development
Hira Shah	Head of Design

Company at a Glance

- **Founded:** 2015
- **Headquarters:** Multan, Pakistan
- **Employees:** 100+ (as of 2026)
- **Projects delivered:** 450+
- **Countries served:** 18, including the USA, UK, UAE, Saudi Arabia, Canada, Germany, and Australia
- **Client retention rate:** 87%

2. Office Location and Contact

Our head office is located at:

DigitalSolutions, 3rd Floor, Tech Plaza, Bosan Road, Multan, Punjab, Pakistan.

The office is 10 minutes from Bahauddin Zakariya University and has free parking for employees and visitors in the building basement.

Contact Details

- **General inquiries:** info@digitalsolutions.example
- **Sales:** sales@digitalsolutions.example
- **HR and careers:** hr@digitalsolutions.example
- **Technical support:** support@digitalsolutions.example
- **Phone:** +92 61 000 1234 (office hours only)

We do not currently have any other branch offices. However, about 15 of our staff work fully remotely from other cities, including Lahore, Islamabad, and Karachi.

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3. Office Timings and Working Days

- **Office hours:** 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM, Pakistan Standard Time (PKT, GMT+5)
- **Working days:** Monday to Friday
- **Weekend:** Saturday and Sunday are off
- **Lunch break:** 1:00 PM to 2:00 PM
- **Friday prayer break:** 1:00 PM to 2:30 PM on Fridays

Employees are expected to arrive by 9:15 AM. Arriving after 9:15 AM is marked as "late." Three late arrivals in one month count as one casual leave.

Flexible Hours

Employees who have completed their probation may request flexible hours, starting any time between 8:00 AM and 11:00 AM, provided they complete 8 working hours and are available for core hours from 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM.

Client Time Zones

Because many clients are in the USA and UK, some team members may work a shifted schedule (for example, 2:00 PM to 11:00 PM PKT). Shifted schedules must be approved by the team lead and HR, and these employees receive an evening shift allowance of PKR 8,000 per month.

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4. Services We Provide

DigitalSolutions provides end-to-end software development services.

4.1 Web Development

We build websites, web applications, dashboards, and e-commerce stores. Common technologies:

- **Frontend:** React, Next.js, Vue.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS
- **Backend:** Node.js, Python (FastAPI, Django), PHP (Laravel)
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis
- **E-commerce:** Shopify, WooCommerce, custom stores

4.2 Mobile App Development

We build Android and iOS apps.

- **Cross-platform:** Flutter and React Native (our preferred approach for most clients)
- **Native:** Kotlin for Android, Swift for iOS
- We also handle publishing apps on the Google Play Store and Apple App Store.

4.3 UI/UX Design

Our design team creates wireframes, prototypes, and complete design systems using Figma. Every project starts with a design phase unless the client provides final designs.

4.4 Artificial Intelligence and Chatbots

Since 2023, we build AI-powered solutions including customer support chatbots, document question-answering systems (RAG), and AI integrations using large language models such as Claude and Gemini.

4.5 Cloud and DevOps

We set up and manage cloud infrastructure on AWS, Microsoft Azure, and Google Cloud, including CI/CD pipelines, Docker, and Kubernetes.

4.6 Quality Assurance (QA)

We offer manual and automated testing using tools such as Selenium, Cypress, and Playwright.

4.7 Maintenance and Support

After a project goes live, we offer monthly maintenance plans that include bug fixes, security updates, and small changes.

Services We Do NOT Provide

- Hardware repair or sales
- Game development
- Blockchain and cryptocurrency projects
- Digital marketing and social media management

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5. Pricing and Project Process

5.1 Pricing Models

1. **Fixed price** - for projects with a clear scope. 40% is paid upfront, 30% at the midpoint, and 30% on delivery.
2. **Hourly (Time and Materials)** - standard rate of USD 25 per hour for developers and USD 35 per hour for senior architects.
3. **Dedicated team** - a client hires a full team monthly. Starts at USD 3,500 per developer per month.

A simple business website usually starts from USD 1,500. A mobile app usually starts from USD 8,000. Final prices depend on features and complexity.

5.2 Project Process

Every project follows these steps:

1. **Discovery call** - a free 30-minute call to understand the client's needs.
2. **Proposal** - sent within 3 working days of the discovery call.
3. **Design** - wireframes and UI designs in Figma.
4. **Development** - work is done in 2-week sprints with a demo at the end of each sprint.
5. **Testing** - the QA team tests everything before release.
6. **Launch** - the project goes live.
7. **Support** - 30 days of free bug-fix support after launch.

5.3 Support Response Times (SLA)

Priority	Example	First response time
Critical	Website or app is down	Within 2 hours
High	A main feature is broken	Within 8 hours

Priority	Example	First response time
Medium	A minor feature issue	Within 1 working day
Low	Small text or design change	Within 3 working days

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6. Salary and Payroll

- **Salary day:** Salaries are paid on the **1st of every month** for the previous month's work.
- If the 1st falls on a weekend or public holiday, salaries are paid on the **last working day before** it.
- Salaries are transferred directly to the employee's bank account. Cash payments are not made.
- **Payslips** are emailed to employees on the same day salaries are paid.
- **Income tax** is deducted at source according to the Government of Pakistan's tax rules.

Annual Increments

Salary increments are given once a year in **July**, based on the annual performance review. Average increments range from 8% to 20%.

Bonuses

- **Eid bonus:** Every permanent employee receives a bonus equal to 50% of their basic salary before Eid ul Fitr.
- **Project bonus:** Teams that deliver a project on time and within budget may receive a project completion bonus.
- **Referral bonus:** PKR 50,000 for referring a candidate who is hired and completes probation.

Overtime

Overtime is paid at **1.5 times** the normal hourly rate. Overtime must be approved in advance by the team lead. Work on public holidays is paid at **2 times** the normal hourly rate.

Advance Salary

Employees may request an advance of up to 50% of their monthly salary, once every 6 months, in case of emergency. It is deducted from the next salary.

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7. Leave Policy

All permanent employees are entitled to the following leave each year (January to December):

Leave type	Days per year
Annual leave	20 days
Sick leave	10 days
Casual leave	10 days
Maternity leave	90 days (fully paid)
Paternity leave	7 days (fully paid)
Marriage leave	5 days (once during employment)
Hajj / Umrah leave	15 days (once during employment)
Bereavement leave	3 days

Rules

- Annual leave must be requested at least **7 days in advance** through the HR portal.
- Sick leave of more than **2 consecutive days** requires a medical certificate.
- Up to **10 unused annual leave days** can be carried forward to the next year. Unused sick and casual leave cannot be carried forward.
- Employees on probation get 1 casual leave per month and no annual leave.
- Leave without approval is treated as unpaid leave.

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8. Public Holidays

DigitalSolutions observes the official public holidays of Pakistan, including:

- Kashmir Solidarity Day - 5 February
- Pakistan Day - 23 March
- Labour Day - 1 May
- Youm-e-Takbeer - 28 May
- Independence Day - 14 August
- Iqbal Day - 9 November
- Quaid-e-Azam Day (also Christmas) - 25 December
- Eid ul Fitr - 3 days
- Eid ul Adha - 3 days
- Ashura - 2 days (9th and 10th Muharram)
- Eid Milad un Nabi - 1 day

Islamic holiday dates depend on the moon sighting. HR announces the final dates by email.

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9. Employee Benefits

- **Medical insurance:** Covers the employee, spouse, and up to 2 children. Hospitalization coverage is up to PKR 300,000 per year per family.
- **Outpatient (OPD) allowance:** PKR 30,000 per year.
- **Provident fund:** The company contributes 8.33% of basic salary, and the employee contributes the same amount. Employees are eligible after 1 year of service.
- **Internet allowance:** PKR 5,000 per month for all employees.
- **Fuel allowance:** PKR 10,000 per month for team leads and above.
- **Laptop:** Every employee receives a company laptop on their first day.
- **Free lunch:** Lunch is provided free of cost in the office every Friday.
- **Learning budget:** Each employee can spend up to PKR 50,000 per year on courses, books, and certifications.
- **Gym membership:** 50% of gym fees are reimbursed, up to PKR 4,000 per month.
- **Annual trip:** The company organizes an annual trip for all staff, usually to the northern areas of Pakistan, such as Hunza or Murree.

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10. Remote and Hybrid Work Policy

- Employees can work from home **every Friday** (hybrid policy), unless their team lead requires them in the office.
- Fully remote positions are offered only for senior roles with at least 4 years of experience.
- Remote employees must be online on Slack during core hours (11:00 AM to 4:00 PM PKT).

- Remote employees must have a stable internet connection of at least 20 Mbps and a backup power solution (UPS or generator), due to load shedding.
- Remote employees must visit the Multan office at least once every quarter. Travel costs for these visits are reimbursed.

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11. Hiring and Onboarding

11.1 Hiring Process

1. Application through our careers page or email to hr@digitalsolutions.example
2. HR screening call (15 minutes)
3. Technical test (take-home, 48 hours to complete)
4. Technical interview with the team lead
5. Final interview with HR and the department head
6. Offer letter, usually within 5 working days of the final interview

11.2 Probation

- New employees are on probation for **3 months**.
- During probation, the notice period is **2 weeks**.
- After probation, the notice period is **1 month** for all employees, and **2 months** for team leads and managers.

11.3 First Day

On the first day, new employees:

- Receive their laptop, email account, and Slack access
- Meet their team lead and are assigned an "onboarding buddy"
- Attend a 1-hour orientation session with HR
- Sign the employment contract and non-disclosure agreement (NDA)

11.4 Internship Program

DigitalSolutions runs a **3-month paid internship program twice a year**, starting in **January and July**. Interns receive a monthly stipend of PKR 25,000. About 60% of interns are offered full-time jobs.

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12. Departments and Team Structure

Department	Approximate size
Web Development	35 people
Mobile App Development	20 people
UI/UX Design	10 people
Quality Assurance	12 people
AI and Data	8 people
DevOps and Cloud	5 people
Project Management	6 people
Sales and Business Development	5 people

Department	Approximate size
Human Resources and Admin	4 people
Finance	3 people

Career Levels

1. Intern
2. Associate Software Engineer
3. Software Engineer
4. Senior Software Engineer
5. Team Lead
6. Engineering Manager
7. Head of Department

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13. Performance Reviews

- Formal performance reviews are held **twice a year**, in **January** and **June**.
- The June review decides the July salary increment.
- Employees are rated on a 5-point scale: 1 (Needs Improvement), 2 (Below Expectations), 3 (Meets Expectations), 4 (Exceeds Expectations), 5 (Outstanding).
- Employees rated 4 or 5 in two reviews in a row are considered for promotion.
- The **"Employee of the Quarter"** award includes a certificate and a cash prize of PKR 25,000.

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14. Code of Conduct

- Treat all colleagues and clients with respect. Harassment and discrimination of any kind are strictly prohibited.
- **Dress code:** Business casual from Monday to Thursday. Casual dress is allowed on Fridays. Formal dress is required for client meetings.
- Smoking is not allowed inside the office. A designated smoking area is available on the rooftop.
- Personal phone calls should be kept short and taken outside the work area.
- Employees may not work for a competitor or take freelance projects in the same field without written approval from HR.
- Complaints can be reported confidentially to HR or through the anonymous form on the HR portal.

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15. IT and Security Policy

- Company laptops must be locked when unattended (Windows + L).
- All employees must use **two-factor authentication (2FA)** for email, Slack, and GitHub.
- Passwords must be at least 12 characters long and changed every 90 days.
- Client code and data must never be uploaded to personal accounts, personal cloud storage, or public AI tools without client approval.
- USB storage devices are blocked on company laptops by default.
- Lost or stolen laptops must be reported to the IT team within **2 hours**.
- The IT helpdesk can be reached on the Slack channel **#it-help**.

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16. Tools We Use

- **Communication:** Slack, Google Meet, Zoom
- **Project management:** Jira and Trello
- **Code hosting:** GitHub
- **Design:** Figma
- **Documentation:** Notion and Confluence
- **HR portal:** used for leave requests, payslips, and attendance

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17. Training and Learning

- **Tech Talk Thursday:** Every Thursday from 4:00 PM to 5:00 PM, an employee presents a technical topic to the team.
- **Hackathon:** An internal 24-hour hackathon is held every year in **December**. The winning team receives PKR 200,000.
- **Mentorship:** Every associate engineer is assigned a senior mentor for their first year.
- **Certifications:** The company pays the exam fee for approved certifications (for example, AWS, Azure, or Google Cloud) if the employee passes.

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18. Travel and Expense Reimbursement

- Business travel must be approved by the department head in advance.
- **Daily allowance:** PKR 6,000 per day for domestic travel.
- Expense claims must be submitted with receipts within **15 days** of the expense.
- Approved claims are paid together with the next monthly salary.

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19. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q: What are the office timings?

A: 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM PKT (GMT+5), Monday to Friday.

Q: When is salary paid?

A: On the 1st of every month. If the 1st is a holiday or weekend, it is paid on the last working day before it.

Q: Where is the office?

A: 3rd Floor, Tech Plaza, Bosan Road, Multan, Punjab, Pakistan.

Q: How many employees does DigitalSolutions have?

A: More than 100 staff members.

Q: Does DigitalSolutions offer work from home?

A: Yes, employees can work from home every Friday. Fully remote roles are available for senior employees with at least 4 years of experience.

Q: How many annual leaves do employees get?

A: 20 days of annual leave, plus 10 sick and 10 casual leaves per year.

Q: Does the company develop mobile apps?

A: Yes, for both Android and iOS, mainly using Flutter and React Native.

Q: Does the company build games?

A: No, game development is not one of our services.

Q: Who is the CEO?

A: Imran Qureshi, who founded the company in 2015.

Q: How long is the probation period?

A: 3 months.

For any questions about this handbook, please contact the HR team at hr@digitalsolutions.example.